

Kai Siren

Staff platform engineer - governed AI systems, developer infrastructure, and production platforms.

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Staff platform engineer building governed AI systems and developer infrastructure.

I'm **Kai Siren** (preferred name), AKA **Lynn Conway** (legal name). I have more than ten years of experience building the systems other engineers rely on. I work across platform engineering, developer experience, observability, and production operations. The current edge of that work is the governed infrastructure around agents: context composition, bounded execution, MCP delivery, model routing, evaluation, and telemetry designed for machine consumers.

The throughline is leverage. I meet engineers where the work is, make the boundary visible, and remove friction between intent and ship. That has meant language-ecosystem tooling at Ruby Together, multi-cloud platforms at Textio, government infrastructure at Nava, and agentic debugging workflows at Kapwing.

My career has been mostly individual-contributor work, with a chapter managing a small DevOps team at EnergyHub. I am strongest in ambiguous systems work where architecture, reliability, and developer experience have to meet.

✦ Open Source

- Ward and agent-compose turn role, tool, and policy inputs into inspectable context, fixed execution workflows, least-access containers, and durable evidence.
- Ward MCP derives bounded MCP and HTTP tools from policy. Agent Proxy routes local and hosted model traffic through one observable OpenAI-compatible surface.

✦ Skills

Languages Python · Go · TypeScript / Node.js · Ruby · Java · PHP

Agent platforms MCP · agent orchestration · context systems · evaluation · model routing · LLM APIs

Cloud and compute AWS · GCP · Azure · Kubernetes · serverless · EC2 · ECS · Batch · Docker · Linux

Infrastructure as code Terraform · CloudFormation · Ansible · Packer · Pulumi

Observability OpenTelemetry · Datadog · Prometheus · Grafana · New Relic · Sentry

Security and governance NIST 800-53 · SOC 2 · ISO 27001 · GDPR · least-privilege tooling

✦ Experience

Kapwing · Senior Software Engineer | San Francisco · 2025 - Present

Python, Node.js, Kubernetes, Terraform, GCP, New Relic, OpenAI Codex

- Improve Dockerized Python startup performance by roughly 2x
- Build video-processing systems with FFmpeg and Puppeteer
- Design agentic debugging workflows that use production observability

Nava · Principal Infrastructure Engineer | Remote · 2023 - 2025

Python, Java, Terraform, AWS, NIST 800-53, New Relic

- Deployed a government website for the US Department of Health and Human Services
- Improved backend applications written in Python and Java
- Remediated security vulnerabilities to maintain NIST 800-53 compliance
- Deployed Metabase for analytics and reporting

Textio · Staff Infrastructure Engineer | Remote · 2022 - 2023

Python, Go, TypeScript, Datadog, Airflow, AWS, Azure, Azure OpenAI, SOC 2

- Deployed Airflow with a SQLMesh orchestration layer for data-science workflows
- Deployed Azure OpenAI through a multi-cloud BGP VPN to AWS
- Migrated monitoring to a customized Datadog and Fluent Bit system
- Built Python data pipelines for customer reporting systems

EnergyHub · DevOps Engineering Manager | Brooklyn, NY · 2021 - 2022

Engineering manager and technical lead for a team of 2 to 4

- Hired a DevOps team and shaped a role distinct from product engineering
- Managed security policy and practice for daily work and significant incidents

EnergyHub · Senior DevOps Engineer | Brooklyn, NY · 2021

Python, Java, Ansible, Terraform, Datadog, MongoDB, AWS, SOC 2

- Stabilized Ansible deployment tooling and brought it to current standards
- Upgraded internal systems to production-grade managed services
- Performed SOC 2 control remediations and built supporting tooling

Bluelink · Senior Backend Engineer | Seattle, WA · 2020 - 2021

Python, Java, GCP, Kubernetes

- Built Java and Python services on Kubernetes and GCP for partner API data flows
- Shipped data-flow products for Democratic candidates and progressives

Textio · Senior Infrastructure Engineer | Seattle, WA · 2018 - 2020

Python, Go, Node.js, GitHub, CircleCI, Docker, AWS ECS, GDPR, ISO 27001

- Built automation across third-party services to improve engineering velocity
- Designed and socialized practices for daily developer tooling
- Built stable developer tools customized to internal use cases

Callisto · Senior Software Engineer | San Francisco, CA · 2016 - 2018

Python, Node.js, Django, Heroku, Travis CI

- Built and upgraded security application logic for the campus product
- Built client-side encryption systems in Python and Node.js
- Paired with cryptographers to prove out novel cryptographic methods

Ruby Together · Open Source Software Engineer | 2016 *Ruby, RubyGems, Bundler, GitHub*

Harlot Media · Software Engineer | 2015 - 2016 *JavaScript, PHP, Bash, DigitalOcean*

Quirell · Software Engineer | 2014 - 2015 *Python, Flask, Neo4j, Heroku*

NASA · Engineering Student Ambassador | 2012 - 2013 *Climate science education*

✦ Community & Open Source Leadership

Write/Speak/Code · Seattle Chapter Organizer | 2019 - 2020

Nonprofit community supporting technologists from marginalized genders

urfave/cli · Maintainer | 2020 - 2021

Go CLI framework with broad downstream adoption

